

Jimmy (Yihang Zhong /i xaŋ tʂuŋ/)

Curriculum Vitae

Department of English

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My research focuses on experimental linguistics (both acquisition and processing), grounded in theories of syntax, semantics, pragmatics, and their interfaces. Ontologically, I appreciate linguistic limits (i.e. how much specific subsystems can vary across languages) and predictors (i.e. what features may co-occur cross-linguistically). Epistemologically, I believe that linguistics is ultimately a part of cognitive science. Hence, I investigate how our language faculty operates during language comprehension and production, and how it integrates into the broader context of the domain-general cognitive system. Methodologically, I employ various behavioral and neural methods to explore the interaction between linguistic theory (both form and meaning) and cognitive architecture.

Research Interests

- Language Acquisition
acquisition of syntax/semantics, child and adult acquisition
- Psycho(-neuro)linguistics
sentence processing grounded in syntax/semantics, neurotypical/neurodivergent processing
- Linguistic Philosophy
history of linguistic thoughts, philosophy of linguistics research

Publication

a=first author; ✉=corresponding author

- | | |
|-----------|---|
| published | Zhong, Y. H. (2024). L2 cognitive construal and morphosyntactic acquisition of pseudo-passive constructions. <i>Linguistics Vanguard</i> (SSCI Q2), 10(1), 147-161.
https://doi.org/10.1515/lingvan-2023-0104 |
| published | Zhong, Y. H. (2024). From generative hierarchicality to parallel-dialogic syntax: |

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	modeling typological protolanguage, <i>SN Social Sciences</i> (Scopus), Springer Nature, 4, 145, https://doi.org/10.1007/s43545-024-00931-8
published	Zhong, Y. H. (2025). Asperger writers' attention & awareness in written production. <i>Language Awareness</i> (SSCI Q1), 1-26, https://doi.org/10.1080/09658416.2025.2556937
published	Chen, J. Q. ^a , Huang, H. Y. ^a , Zhong, Y. H. ^a ✉, Ling, L., Hu, K., Luo, Y. L. & Li, H. H. (2025). Reading-selective cerebellar areas In bilingual readers. <i>Brain & Language</i> (SSCI Q1), 279, 105770. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bandl.2026.105770
published	Hao, J. J. & Zhong, Y. H. ✉ (2026). Effects of syntactic role on processing pronoun resolution. <i>International Review Of Applied Linguistics</i> (SSCI Q1). https://doi.org/10.1515/iral-2025-0185
1st round peer review	Zhong, Y. H. (2023). Adaptive lexical inference under input uncertainty. <i>Cognitive Processing</i> (SSCI Q3)
2nd round peer review after major revision	Zhong, Y. H. (2024). Semantic-pragmatic constraints on Chinese genitive constructions. <i>Studia Linguistica</i> (SSCI Q4)
1st round peer review	Zhong, Y. H. (2025). Aspect in telicity acquisition: evidence from Mandarin children. <i>Language Learning & Development</i> (SSCI Q2)
1st round peer review	Zhong, Y. H. (2025). Can the Galilean ideal of generative linguistics be sustained? <i>International Studies In The Philosophy Of Science</i> (AHCI)
1st round peer review	Zhong, Y. H. & Li, H. H.* (2025). L1 & L2 processing of counterfactual conditionals: evidence from fMRI. <i>Journal Of Neuroscience Research</i> (SCIE Q2), registered report stage 1
1st round peer review	Zhong, Y. H. (2026). Titularity & disciplinary identity. <i>Philosophia</i> (AHCI)

Employment

2026.04-now	Institute of Psychology of The Chinese Academy of Sciences Research assistant (in the field of psycholinguistics)
2025.06-2025.12	School of Psychology, Shenzhen University, China Research assistant (in the field of neurolinguistics with an fMRI focus)

Education

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- 2022.08-2023.07 M.A. (Applied Linguistics), The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong, China
 Full-time student representative nominated by the department
Self-directed thesis: Asperger Writers' Attention & Awareness In Written Production (Currently published by *Language Awareness*, SSCI Q1)
 GPA: 3.5/4
- 2019.03-2021.12 B.A. (Linguistics), Adelaide University, Adelaide, South Australia, Australia
 GPA: 6.75/7
- 2021.06-2021.10 Advanced Diploma of Translating, Sydney Institute of Interpreting & Translating, Australia
- 2021.01-2021.06 Diploma of Interpreting, Australian Ideal College, Australia

Summer School

- 2024.07-2024.08 *Core Courses In Linguistics*, Beijing Institute Of Technology, Beijing, China
 Organizer: The Linguistics Institute of China
- 600-hour intensive training in phonetics, phonology, syntax, and semantics
 - daily lectures, weekly assignments and exams
 - high familiarity of generative linguistic analysis across core modules
- 2023.07 *Time & Cognition*, Peking University, Beijing, China
- self-directed study in the field of semantic & syntactic processing with neurolinguistic methodology
 - engagement in reading discussion groups
 - formulation of a new neurolinguistic research proposal (title: *L1 Processing Of Counterfactual Conditionals With Modality: Evidence From ERPs*)

Invited Conference Presentations

- 2023.07.15 2023 Hong Kong Association for Applied Linguistics (HAAL) Conference, Hang Seng University of Hong Kong, Shatin, Hong Kong, China
- Paper Presentation: *Adaptive lexical inference under input uncertainty*
- 2023.08.31-09.02 2023 Architectures & Mechanisms For Language Processing-Asia Conference, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong, China

- Poster Presentation: *Adaptive lexical inference under input uncertainty*
- 2023.11.04-11.05 2023 Applied Linguistic Research (ALR) Symposium, Prince Sultan University, Saudi Arabia
- Poster presentation: *L2 Cognitive Construal & Morpho-syntactic Acquisition Of Pseudo-passive Construction*
 - Paper Presentation: *Adaptive lexical inference under input uncertainty*
- 2023.11.19-11.21 2023 Applied Linguistics Association of Australia (ALAA) Conference, The University of Wollongong, Wollongong, New South Wales, Australia
- Paper Presentation: *L2 Cognitive Construal & Morpho-syntactic Acquisition Of Pseudo-passive Construction*
 - Paper Presentation: *Adaptive lexical inference under input uncertainty*
- 2023.11.29-12.01 2023 Australian Linguistic Society (ALS) Conference, University of Sydney, Sydney, New South Wales, Australia
- Paper Presentation: *L2 Cognitive Construal & Morpho-syntactic Acquisition Of Pseudo-passive Construction*
 - Paper Presentation: *Adaptive lexical inference under input uncertainty*
 - Paper Presentation: *Asperger Writers' Attention & Awareness In Written Production*
- 2024.06.21-06.22 2024 International Conference On Linguistics & Language Studies, Hong Kong Metropolitan University, Hong Kong, China
- Paper Presentation: *From Generative Hierarchicality To Parallel-dialogic Syntax: Modeling Typological Protolanguage*
- 2026.06.22 2026 Oxford Postgraduate Conference In Linguistics, University of Oxford, Oxford, Britain
- Poster presentation: *Aspect In Telicity Acquisition: Evidence From Mandarin Children*

Professional Service

Journal reviewer

Applied Linguistics (SSCI Q1)

Humanities & Social Sciences Communications (SSCI Q1 & AHCI)

Forum For Linguistic Studies

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Media Engagement

- Content creation about popular science articles on social media
- *Does linguistics truly research “language”? Syntactic theory→language acquisition→AI*
- *Linguistics VS psychology: how they study psycholinguistics in their own way*
- *The survival predicament of niche disciplines and what constitutes truly important research*
- *Review of SSCI linguistics journals*
- *A video takes you through the development of modern linguistics over the past century*
- *Where is the future path for us who study linguistics?*

Technical Skills

Statistics

Python, R Studio, SPSS

Laboratory

Praat

Translation

English-Chinese bidirectional translation

Representative work (English→Chinese in about 90000 characters):

Witting, A. (1989). *I For Isobel*. Penguin Books.

Languages

Native

Mandarin Chinese

Advanced

English

Basic

French

Courses Taken (Selected)

- | | | |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| ● Syntax | ● Second Language Acquisition | ● Linguistics & Translation |
| ● Semantics | ● Cognitive Linguistics | ● Lexicology |
| ● Phonology | ● Interdisciplinary Approaches | ● Language Variation & |
| ● Phonetics | To Multilingualism | Change |
| ● Theoretical Linguistics | ● Psycholinguistics | ● Sociolinguistics |
| ● Research Methods In | ● Time & Cognition | ● Language & Society |
| Applied Linguistics | ● Phonological Acquisition | |

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References

- Dr. Anh Lee, College of Nursing & Health Sciences, Flinders University
(anh.le@flinders.edu.au)
- Assistant Prof. Hehui Li, School of Psychology, Shenzhen University, China
(hehuili@szu.edu.cn)
- Associate Prof. Ying Li, Institute of Psychology of the Chinese Academy of Sciences
(liying@psych.ac.cn)
- Prof. Jinglian Li, Department of Foreign Languages, Beijing Institute of Technology
(ljl@bit.edu.cn)